

Junho Kim

Department of Economics
Indiana University Bloomington
jk291@iu.edu | jjunok.github.io

Research Fields

International Trade, Political Economy, Geopolitics

Education

Indiana University Bloomington Bloomington, IN
Ph.D. in Economics, Expected May 2027

Indiana University Bloomington Bloomington, IN
M.A. in Economics, 2025

Yonsei University Seoul, South Korea
B.A. in Economics, 2014

Working Papers

“Tariffs as Economic Statecraft: Evidence from the Hegemon-Periphery Relationship”
(Job Market Paper) *with Mostafa Beshkar*

Abstract: Tariffs have long been understood as a tool of economic statecraft, used not only to manage trade but to extract political returns from trading partners. This may be why tariff-cut commitments so often look lopsided: a hegemon may offer periphery countries deeper cuts than it receives in return, with the imbalance possibly compensated on a different margin, namely political concessions. Using the United States as the hegemon and UN General Assembly voting as our measure of political concessions, we measure economic concessions as the terms-of-trade effect of bilateral tariff cuts and exploit variation in their value over time. We find that periods of larger tariff concessions from the US are also periods of greater political concessions by periphery countries. This holds even absent new tariff policy: a tariff schedule’s economic value is continuously revalued by shifting trade patterns, and the political returns to a concession made years earlier track this revaluation.

“Trade Imbalances and Reciprocity in the WTO: A Rule-Based Adjustment Framework” *with Mostafa Beshkar*

Abstract: This paper examines the erosion of reciprocity in the global trading system and identifies persistent trade imbalances as a key driver of deviations in trade concessions from their original WTO benchmark. We develop a multi-country structural trade model that endogenizes trade imbalances and quantifies the tariff adjustments required to restore reciprocity. Our results reveal a strong relationship between bilateral trade imbalances and reciprocity-restoring tariff changes: countries associated with larger U.S. trade deficits require systematically larger tariff increases. Motivated by these findings, we propose a rule-based policy framework inspired by Keynes’s principle of symmetric adjustment that prioritizes minimally distortionary instruments. The framework introduces a hierarchical mechanism consisting of imbalance-based fee charges, followed by targeted tariff reductions by surplus countries, and tariff increases by deficit countries as a last resort. This sequencing preserves existing trade relationships while enabling gradual correction of imbalances.

Our analysis highlights the need for coordinated and adaptive policy mechanisms to maintain reciprocity in a dynamic global trading system.

“Rebalancing Supply Networks after a Geopolitical Shock ”

Abstract: This paper studies how import sourcing networks adjust to geopolitical supply shocks. Using the 2019 Korea–Japan trade dispute, I show that imports from Japan declined more for products with concentrated alternative sourcing, while imports from third countries increased relatively more. The adjustment occurred primarily through rebalancing within pre-existing supplier relationships rather than through an expansion in the number of supplier countries. Within these relationships, imports also shifted relatively away from countries with greater pre-dispute geopolitical risk.

Work in Progress

“Geopolitical Risk and Domestic Innovation”

“Political Shocks, Exit, and the Stability of the WTO”

Policy Papers

“Steady Growth of the Pharmaceutical Industry in Chungbuk”

BOK Golden Book, Bank of Korea, December 2018.

“Protectionism Status and Its Impact on Korean Exports” *with J. Park and B. Kim*

Economic Outlook, Bank of Korea, January 2017.

“Import Growth Outlook of Trading Partners Considering Changes in the Global Trade Structure” *with H. Lee*

Economic Outlook, Bank of Korea, October 2016.

Presentations

Hoosier Economics Conference	2024
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Teaching Experience

Indiana University Bloomington

Assistant Instructor

Fundamentals of Economics for Business II	Spring 2025, Fall 2025
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	
Fundamentals of Economics II	Spring 2026
Introduction to Macroeconomics	Spring 2026
Fundamentals of Economics for Business II	Summer 2025
Introduction to Applied Econometrics	Fall 2024, Fall 2022
Fundamentals of Economics for Business I	Spring 2024, Fall 2023
Statistical Analysis for Business and Economics	Spring 2023
Intermediate Microeconomic Theory	Fall 2022

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Prof. Mostafa Beshkar

Summer 2025

Professional Experience

Bank of Korea

Economist

2020–2022

Office of Bank Examination

Junior Economist

2014–2019

Economic Statistics Department, Research Department, and Chungbuk Branch

Fellowships, Honors & Awards

Lloyd Orr Graduate Fellowship, Indiana University

Fall 2026

Tobias Center Research Fund Grant, Indiana University

Fall 2025

Susan C. Thrasher Fellowship, Indiana University

Spring 2025, Fall 2025

Governor's Encouragement Award, Bank of Korea

June 2019

Skills

Programming: MATLAB, Stata, R, Python

Languages: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)

References

Beshkar Mostafa(Chair)

Associate Professor

Department of Economics, Indiana University

mbeshkar@iu.edu

Gustavo Torrents

Associate Professor

Department of Economics, Indiana University

gtorrents@iu.edu

Emerson C. Melo

Associate Professor

Department of Economics, Indiana University

emelo@iu.edu

Sarah Bauerle Danzman

Associate Professor

International Studies, Indiana University

sbauerle@iu.edu